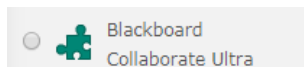


Activities: Blackboard Collaborate Ultra



The Blackboard Collaborate Ultra activity allows you to create a Webinar or virtual classroom for your students. The main Blackboard Collaborate tool is an interactive whiteboard; instructors may use the whiteboard to write on, upload PowerPoints, conduct polls and quizzes and use breakout rooms. Instructors may also have students view their desktop to view Word, Excel or Internet pages. Instructors are able to show themselves on camera and chat with the students via a chat area. The sessions may be recorded for asynchronous viewing and review.

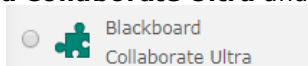
Besides using Blackboard Collaborate Ultra as an online classroom, you can also use this tool for instructor office hours, where students may drop in virtually to ask questions, to conduct homework reviews, and to demonstrate how to complete assignments or work through course content.

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3. [Opening an Ultra Session](#)
 - [Join a Collaborate session on Moodle](#)
 - [Audio and video setup](#)
4. [Using the Features of Blackboard Ultra](#)
 - [Record a Session/Retrieve a Recording](#)
 - [Chat with Participants](#)
 - [Share Blank Whiteboard](#)
 - [Share Application](#)
 - [Share Files](#)
 - [Polling](#)
 - [Breakout Groups](#)
5. [Ultra Settings](#)

Accessing Blackboard Collaborate Ultra

1. Go to your **Moodle course page**.
2. Click on the **Turn editing on** button at the top right of the screen.
3. Click **Add an activity or resource**. 
4. Click the **radio** button next to **Blackboard Collaborate Ultra** and click on the **Add** button (the icon should be a green puzzle piece).



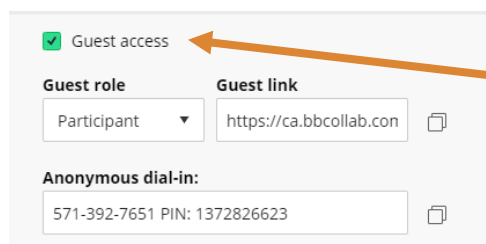
The **Adding a new External Tool** page will appear (Blackboard Ultra is an External Tool in Moodle).

5. Give the activity a name – NOTE: this isn't the name of your Ultra session, just the name given to the activity within Moodle.
6. In the **Privacy** section, **uncheck** 'Accept grades from the tool', so that your Blackboard Ultra activity **does not show in your gradebook**. No other settings need to be adjusted, so click the **Save and return to course** button.

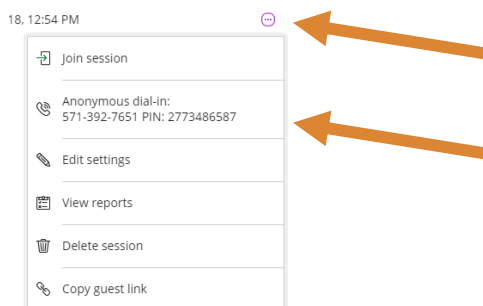
NOTE: you do NOT need to create separate Moodle activities if you have multiple Ultra sessions (ie. one for seminars and one for office hours). All activities created in a Moodle course page will point to the same Blackboard Collaborate Ultra sessions page. You can create separate sessions on this page.

Ultra Settings

1. **Click** on the **Create Session** button. A side menu will pop out from the right.
2. Type a **Session name**. The title of this session depends on whether you are opening a session for one class or the entire term. Make a title that will clearly communicate the session agenda to the students. Examples: *Biology 20 A01 Daily Webinars (Weekdays at 10:00 am)* or *Biology 20 A01 Homework Help Online Class (Mondays 8:00 pm)*. Please include the class you are teaching in the title, so that this session will be easier for E&IT to locate in case of a disruption.
3. Set whether you will allow Collaborate guest access – this is useful if you are using Ultra for a conference webinar, for example. You can also set what kind of role the guest will receive upon logging into Collaborate (you can set guests to log in as a Participant, a Moderator, or a Presenter).



4. Set the time the **Session begins** and the **Session ends**. You can also set **Early Entry** options (useful if you have a separate session for each day).
 - If you are making one Collaborate session for the entire semester, adjust the timing to cover the duration of the course (eg. January 6 to April 21). You also have the option of 'No end', which will your session continuous with no end.
 - If you are making Collaborate sessions to place within the modules, set the timing for the specific session. You can make this session a repeat session, which will give you options to set the session to repeat daily, weekly, or monthly.
5. The **Session Settings** option has a few useful settings to consider:
 - **Default Attendee Role:** Set what kind of role attendees will have when they enter the session (Participant, Moderator, Presenter)
 - **Allow recording downloads:** This allows students to download recordings.
 - **Anonymize chat messages:** This option strips the name and profile off of chat messages in the recording, making participants (including moderators) anonymous when the recording is viewed (this does not affect the live session).
 - **Show profile pictures for moderator only:** Participants will not be able to upload a profile picture. Moderators will still have this ability.
 - **Participants can share audio:** You can turn this off so only moderators can share audio.
 - **Participants can share video:** You can turn this off so students are not able to share video from their webcams.
 - **Participants can post chat messages:** This allows students to participate in the chat room by posting messages.
 - **Participants can draw on whiteboard and files:** This setting allows students to draw on the whiteboard and uploaded PowerPoints, photos, or PDFs.
 - **Allow attendees to join the session using a telephone:** On by default, this setting allows students to join by calling a phone number and entering a PIN. Information required is available by clicking on the ellipsis 'three dots' icon on the far right of the session link after clicking on the Blackboard Ultra activity in Moodle):

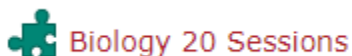


- **Participants can only chat privately with moderators:** It is recommended you limit private chats to between student and moderators only.
- **Moderators supervise all private chats:** moderators will be able to see all private chats, including those between students (**highly recommended**).

Opening a Collaborate Session

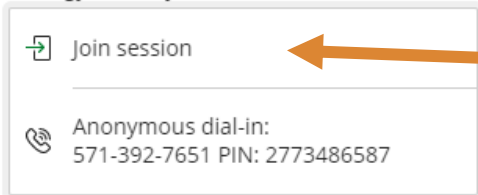
Joining a Collaborate Session on Moodle

1. Click on the **Ultra** activity.



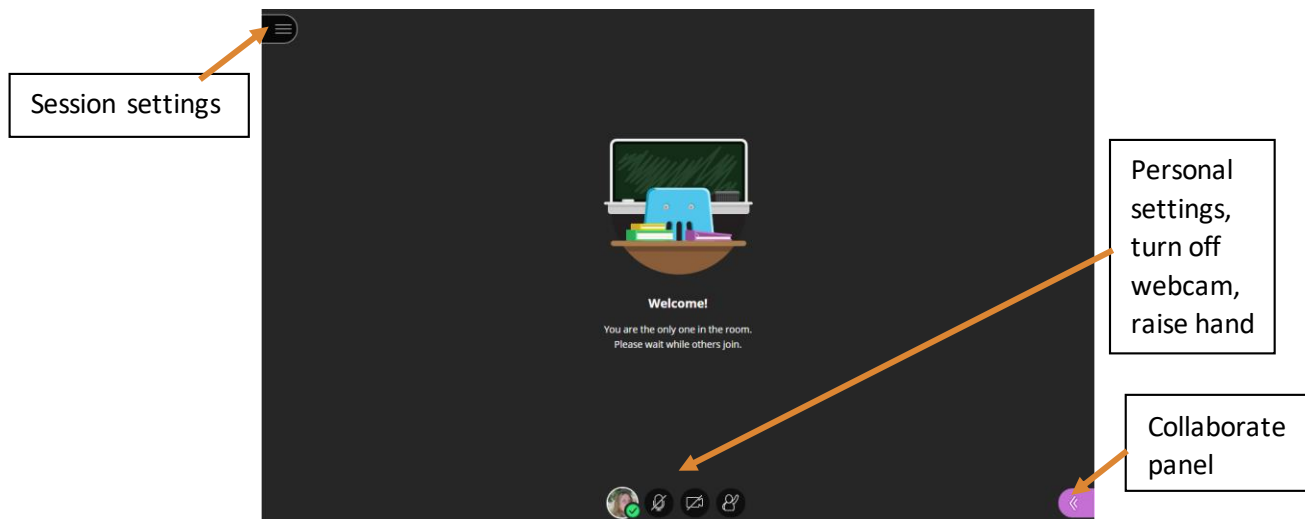
2. Click on the **Session link**. You will get a popup menu with two options: Join session, and Anonymous dial-in. **Click on Join session.**

Biology 20 Daily Sessions A01 (Winter 2018)



3. Collaborate will start loading.

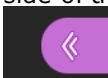
If this is your first time logging into a Collaborate session, you have the option to go through a quick tutorial on the features. You may skip this tutorial if you like.



Session settings – click this tab to access options for recording of the session, using your phone for audio, reporting issues to Blackboard, Help topics, access the tutorial again, and leaving the session.

Audio and video setup

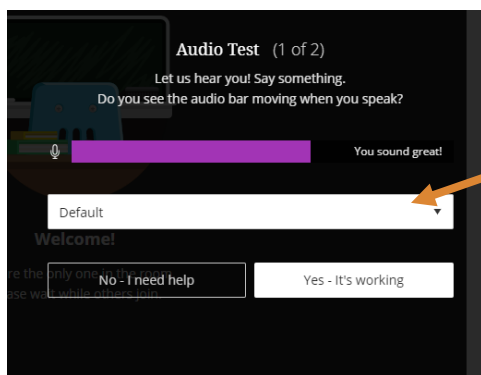
1. Every time you start BBC, make sure to configure your camera and microphone settings. To do this, click on the **Open Collaborate menu** tab (purple-coloured tab on the bottom right hand side of the page).



2. From the side panel that appears, select the **Settings** (gear) icon at the bottom of the panel that pops out.



3. **Click on Set up your camera and microphone.** If your camera or microphone do not work, try changing your input by using the dropdown menu and choosing another input option.



Input dropdown menu

4. If the microphone or camera you are currently testing out is working, click the **Yes – It's working** button.
5. When you are ready, click the Microphone and Video icons on the bottom of the page to share your audio and video with all participants.



Not shared



Shared

Using the Features of Blackboard Ultra

Record a Session/Retrieve a Recording:

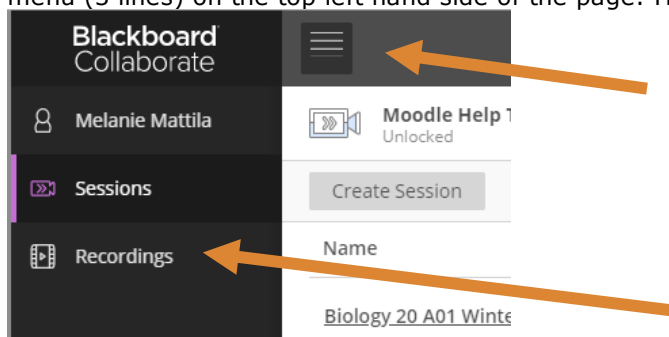
1. On the top left hand side of the screen, click the black **Open Session menu** button.



2. The first option available to you is **Start Recording**. Click this option and the session will start recording. The **Open Session menu** tab will now have a small Recording icon beside it.



3. To stop recording, click on the **Stop Recording** option in the **Open Session menu** tab.
Note: To retrieve a previous recording, on the Sessions list screen, click on the hamburger menu (3 lines) on the top left hand side of the page. Then click on **Recordings**.



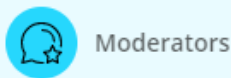
Chat with Participants

As a moderator, there are three ways you can chat with others currently logged into the same session. All three ways are available by clicking on the **Open Collaborate panel** tab (purple tab on bottom right).

1. **To chat with everyone:** Click on the **Everyone** option.



2. **To chat with moderators ONLY:** Click on the **Moderators** option



3. **To chat with an individual participant privately:** Click on the **Participants** icon at the bottom of the Collaborate panel. Click on the **Participant controls** button beside a participant's name to access the Private Chat option with that participant.



Melanie Mattila



Share Blank Whiteboard

Like previous versions of Blackboard Collaborate, Ultra has a whiteboard you can write on and interact with. To share a blank whiteboard, click on the **Open Collaborate panel** tab (purple tab) and select **Share Content**. Click on **Share Blank Whiteboard**.

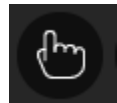


NOTE: Unlike previous versions of Blackboard Collaborate, Ultra only has one whiteboard page. **You cannot create additional whiteboard pages.** A workaround is to include blank slides in your Powerpoint presentations. **Please note that annotations are not saved** on these slides, so if you navigate to a new slide, you will lose annotations on old slides.

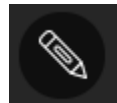
Whiteboard Interaction Features:



Select tool: select objects (eg. drawings, shapes) already on the whiteboard.



Pointer tool: point at objects on the whiteboard.



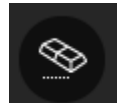
Pencil tool: draw on the whiteboard.



Shapes tool: add shapes (rectangles, ellipses, lines) to the whiteboard.



Text tool: add text to the whiteboard.



Clear tool: clears the entire whiteboard.



Colors tool: pick the colour used for the pencil (only appears when Pencil tool is selected).

View Controls:



Show View Controls: Show the options for viewing (eg. zoom in and out).



Zoom in: Zooms in on the content, making it appear larger.



Zoom out: Zooms out, making objects appear smaller.



Best fit: Finds the best size for the content, depending on the size of the browser window.



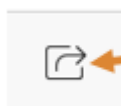
Actual size: resets the content back to its actual size.

To stop sharing the whiteboard: click on the **Stop Sharing** button (top right hand side of the screen)



Share Application

Like previous versions of Blackboard Collaborate, Ultra allows you to share applications (eg. a webpage, PowerPoint) or your desktop. To share your desktop or an application click on the **Open Collaborate panel** tab (purple tab) and select **Share Content**. Click on **Share Application**.

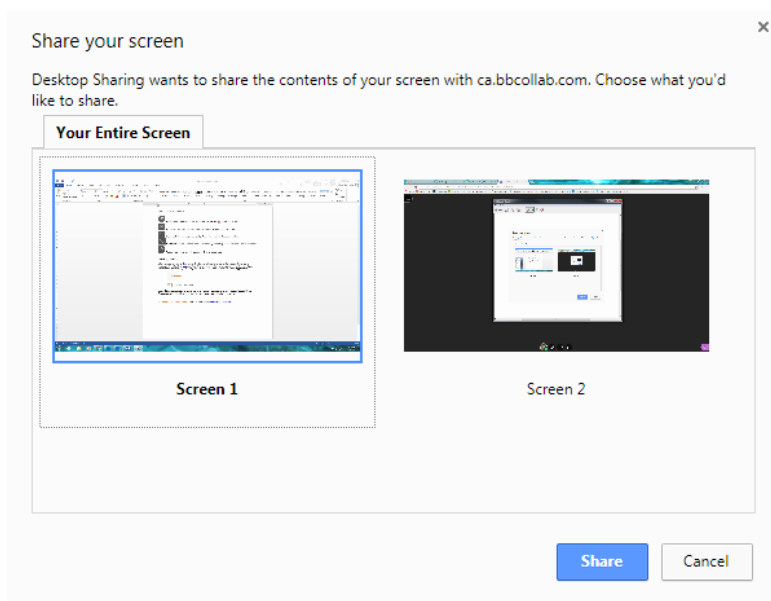


Share Application

You will then be prompted to show your entire screen (desktop) or choose a specific application. Please note that you will need to have the application open in order to select it.

Share Screen:

If you choose the 'Entire Screen' option, you will be presented with a popup box where you can confirm that you would like to share your desktop. If you have two screens, you will be prompted to select one of two screens to share. Click **Share** when you are ready.

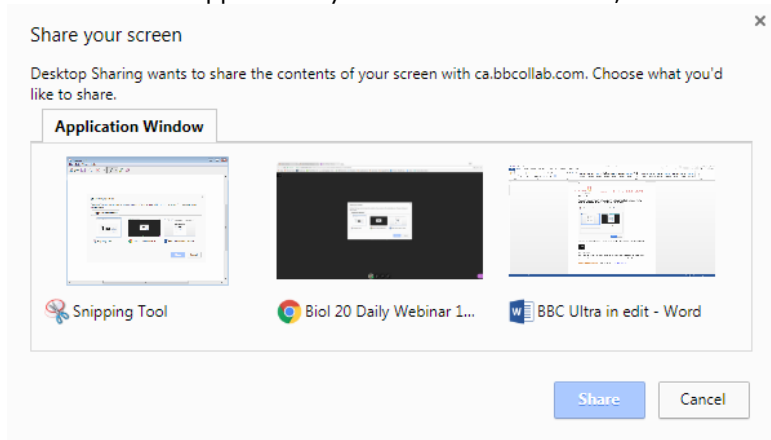


When you are finished sharing your screen, click on the **Stop Sharing** button on the top right hand side of the screen.



Share Application:

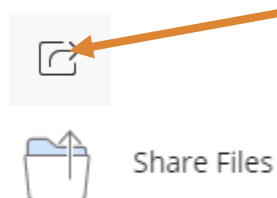
If you choose the 'Just an Application' option, you will be presented with a popup box where you can choose the application you would like to share. The application must already be open in order to share it. Click on the application you would like to share, and click **Share**.



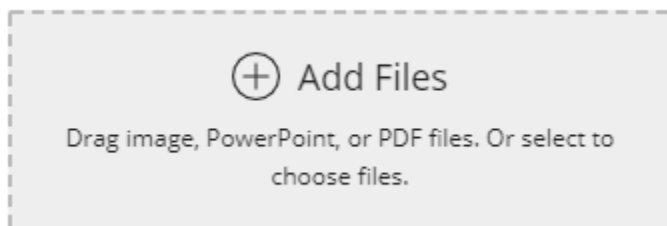
When you are finished sharing your screen, click on the **Stop Sharing** button on the top right hand side of the screen.

Share Files

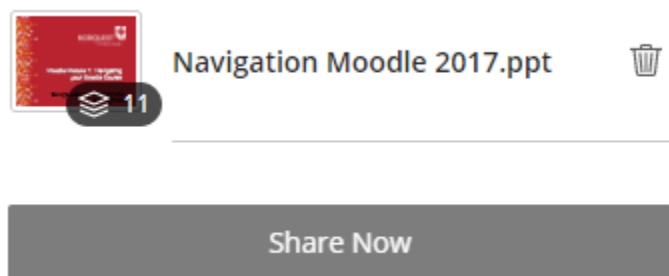
This option is similar to the 'Load Content' button on classic Blackboard Collaborate, where you could upload a PowerPoint to the whiteboard. To share a file, click on the **Open Collaborate panel** tab (purple tab) and click on **Share Content**. Click on **Share Files**.



A new panel will open, with a box at the top for adding files (**NOTE:** images, PowerPoints, and PDF files only). You can drag files into this box, or click on the box itself to navigate to where your files are located.



You can have several files added to your session. All files you've added will show in this panel. Click on a file and then click on the **Share Now** button on the bottom of the panel to share the file with participants and interact with it.



In sharing mode, if you are sharing a PowerPoint, all slides will be previewed in the panel on the right hand side of the screen. Click on a slide to show it to participants. You can also use the **arrow** buttons at the bottom of the currently presented slide to move to the next slide.

< Slides

Select a slide to navigate to

02

Icebreaker

- Introduce yourself, the department you are from and answer the following question.
- What do you think needs to be included in a good quality course?

03

Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this Workshop you will be able to:
- Edit your Profile
- Customize settings - messages
- Navigate Moodle (dashboard and your course)
- Turn editing mode on and modify the template
- Create a block
- Edit Calendar
- Switch your role from teacher to student

Slide Previews - Click to share with your participants.

Navigation buttons

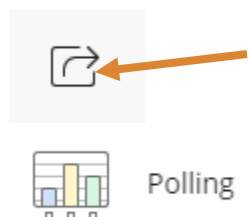
← Navigation Moodle 2017.ppt (2/11) →

You will have the same tools for annotation that you do when you are using the Whiteboard function. **HOWEVER, your annotations will not be saved when you move to another slide.** If you move to another slide and then need to move back, **you will lose your annotations on that slide.**

To stop sharing your file, click on the **Stop Sharing** button on the top right hand side of the screen.

Polling

You can set up quick class polls in your session by using the Polling feature. To use this feature, click on the **Open Collaborate panel** tab (purple tab). Click on **Share Content**, and then click on **Polling**.



The Polling option will give you Yes/No choices, or 2-5 choices for a multiple choice type of question. Please note that you cannot add answers to these choices (the choices remain generic), so your questions will need to be made beforehand in a PowerPoint or other type of file to share with participants.

The screenshot shows a poll titled "4 Choices". At the top right is a "Stop polling" button. Below the title is a table of poll results:

Choice	Count
No Response	1
1	0
2	0
3	0
4	0

At the bottom left is a "Lock Poll" button. Annotations with arrows point to the following elements:

- Stop polling**: Points to the "Stop polling" button.
- Choice number**: Points to the "1" in the "No Response" row.
- Number of participants who picked this choice**: Points to the "0" in the row for choice "2".
- Lock poll to prevent participants from making a choice.**: Points to the "Lock Poll" button.

Breakout Groups

You can set up breakout groups in your session for students to work together privately in groups, with their own whiteboard space. To use this feature, click on the **Open Collaborate panel** tab (purple tab). Click on **Share Content**, and then click on **Breakout Groups**.



With this feature, you can choose to assign participants to groups yourself (custom assignment), or allow Ultra to assign groups automatically. In this panel, you can also add and subtract breakout rooms as needed, and drag participants into these rooms. When you are ready, press **Start** (bottom of the panel) to move participants to their breakout rooms.

The screenshot shows the 'Assign Groups' interface in Blackboard Collaborate Ultra. At the top, there is a dropdown menu set to 'Custom assignment'. Below it is a checkbox labeled 'Allow participants to switch groups' which is checked. An annotation box points to this checkbox with the text: 'Allows participants to freely move between groups.' Below the checkbox is a section titled 'Main Room'. Inside this section, there is a participant card for 'Melanie Mattila' with a profile picture. An annotation box points to this card with the text: 'Click and drag on the participant's name to move it to a group.' Below the 'Main Room' section, there are two group boxes. The first is 'Group 1' with '0 members' and a trash icon. An annotation box points to the trash icon with the text: 'Delete a group.' The second is 'Group 2' with '0 members' and a trash icon. Below 'Group 2' is a plus sign icon in a circle. An annotation box points to this icon with the text: 'Add a group.' At the bottom of the interface are two buttons: 'Cancel' and 'Start'. An annotation box points to the 'Start' button with the text: 'Start the breakout groups.'

When you have finished with the breakout groups, press **Stop** () to move everybody back to the main room.

NOTE: If you are not in the same room as students, you will not be able to hear them (and they will not be able to hear you). If you would like to speak to students in a group, you will need to move yourself into that room.

Ultra Settings

If you are having difficulty with your webcam or your microphone, you can adjust these settings using the **Settings** panel. You can also use this panel to adjust notifications of activities (eg. chat room responses), and give permissions to participants so they can share audio and video as well. To go to your settings, click on the **Open Collaborate panel** tab (purple tab). Click on **Share Content**, and then click on **Breakout Groups**.

The screenshot shows the 'My Settings' panel in Blackboard Collaborate Ultra. It includes sections for 'Audio and Video Settings' and 'Notification Settings'. Callout boxes with arrows point to specific features: a status dropdown, camera/microphone setup, volume sliders, closed captions, and session permissions.

My Settings

Melanie Mattila
Present ▼

Audio and Video Settings

Set up your camera and microphone

Use your phone for audio

Speaker Volume
0% 100%

Microphone Volume
0% 100%

☐ Display Closed Captions (when available)

Notification Settings

Session Settings

Report an issue

Set your status (Present, Away, etc.), or give feedback to the presenter (Faster, Slower, etc.). Clicking on the picture will allow you to upload a profile picture.

Set up your camera, microphone, or adjust audio settings

Set notifications for whenever a participant joins/leaves a session, posts a chat message, or raises their hand.

Set permissions for participants (sharing audio and video, posting in chat, drawing on the whiteboard)

For additional information, contact Moodle Help at moodle@norquest.ca